```
// negative offset counts from end of string
var_dump(substr_compare($mijRG, 'O Genesis', -9, 9));
// turn off case sensitivity
var_dump(substr_compare($mijRG, 'O gEnEsIs', -9, 9, true));
```

```
Output:
int(0)
int(-9)
int(0)
int(0)
int(0)
```

I highly recommend that if you use this function, that length is *always* specified. It is possible to omit this argument (or pass `null` when also providing an explicit argument for case sensitivity), but the default value for length is not particularly intuitive. Rather than simply being the length of the second string parameter, it is in fact one of two values: either the length of the second parameter or the length of the first parameter minus the offset, whichever is larger.

```
var_dump(substr_compare($mijRG, 'Ibanez', 0));
```

```
Output:
int(1)
```

The example above might seem intuitive on first glance, but as we can see from the output, the result is that whatever substring of `$mijRG` we ended up with, it is not equal to the string literal `'Ibanez'`. Without an explicit length argument, the default value is a choice of either *6* (the length of the string `'Ibanez'`) or *21* (the length of `$mijRG` minus an offset of *0*); *21* is larger, so the function call ends up being the equivalent of `substr_compare($mijRG, 'Ibanez', 0, 21);` and the return is *1*. `$mijRG` is greater than the string `'Ibanez'` (of course it is; it has more bytes). In truth, I have rarely seen this function used in the wild, and any code that needs to search sub-strings for patterns usually ends up being a regular expression or multiple function calls (one to extract the necessary sub-string and another to do the comparison). Nevertheless, you might encounter it on your travels, so you need to know what it does. One more thing: if you're this far into the section and starting to wonder why `substr_compare()` uses a function parameter to control case-sensitivity, but other functions have named equivalents (e.g., why isn't there just another parameter for `strcmp()` to control that behavior, why do we